MIDI Bridge - dLive

Quick reference — controls & first-run setup

A menu bar app keeping a permanent two-way link between your DAW and the dLive: it creates the “dLive Bridge” virtual MIDI ports and shuttles everything to the console over the network (MIDI over TCP).

Menu bar disc

Click	Show / hide the control panel.
Right-click	Show MIDI Monitor, Reload MIDI Monitor, or Quit (Quit is also in the panel footer).
Disc colour	Grey outline = stopped · Red = no connection · Amber, breathing = connecting · Green = connected · Cyan flash = MIDI flowing · Amber ! = error (click the status tile to open the log).

First-run setup

Console IP / Port	The MixRack’s address. Port defaults to 51325 (dLive MIDI over TCP).
Base MIDI Channel	Must match Utility → Control → MIDI on the console.
Your DAW	Restart your DAW after the bridge’s first start so “dLive Bridge” appears in its MIDI output list.

Options

Auto-reconnect	On: after a drop the bridge retries hard for 30 s, then every 30 s. Off: it stays red until you click Restart Bridge.
Verbose logging	Writes every MIDI message with raw bytes to the log. Debugging only — the log grows quickly.
Start at login	Launches the bridge with the Mac (default on).
Option key (held)	Reveals “Edit config file…” for advanced settings.

MIDI monitor

Panel peek	The last 5 MIDI events, live, under MIDI ACTIVITY.
Show MIDI Monitor…	The full stream: filter by direction, type or source, search, pause, click a row for raw bytes. Open it from the panel, or by right-clicking the menu bar disc.
Finding the window again	While the monitor is open the app appears in the Dock and in Cmd-Tab, and the window is listed in the Window menu. It follows you to whichever desktop Space you are on, and keeps its log when you reopen it.
Source labels	Every row is tagged with where it came from — your DAW, the console’s surface, the bridge’s own housekeeping, or a connected app by name (e.g. “Pilot Tone Trigger”). Use the source menu to watch one at a time.
Actions	Outgoing Control Changes on the base channel are shown as probable console Actions. Which Action a CC triggers is bound on the console, so the bridge flags the intent, not the name.
Simple / Advanced view	The monitor hides low-level protocol scaffolding by default; switch to **Advanced** to see everything on the wire — fader pings, heartbeat probes, NRPN address messages — for deep debugging.
The two dots	“bridge” = link to the bridge app; “console” = the bridge’s link to the desk — only the second means you reach the console.

Sharing the console

One link, many apps	Other software can reach the desk through the bridge instead of opening its own connection to the console. Talk Light Trigger, Pilot Tone Trigger and Console Control do this automatically when pointed at the “dLive Bridge” port, and Bitfocus Companion can connect to the bridge too.
Why it helps	One link to the console instead of several, and each app’s traffic is labelled by name in the monitor, so you can see exactly what sent what.
dLive Bridge Return	Console activity is passed back to your DAW on this second port. The bridge’s own background housekeeping is not, so it no longer clutters what your DAW receives.

Running it

Start / Stop / Restart	Controls the bridge process. After changing a connection setting, click Restart Bridge to apply it.
Status tile	Mirrors the menu bar disc, plus host, last activity and msg/s.

Important — if the bridge sits at “Connecting…” while the desk is reachable, another controller may be holding the console’s MIDI-over-TCP port. Quit the A&H MIDI Driver (or other control software) and click Restart Bridge.

What's new in v1.1.4

• If another copy of MIDI Bridge is already running, the app now says so and tells you how to fix it, instead of reporting only "Bridge exited with code 1". It also names the program holding the port, and suggests restarting your Mac if a leftover background process is to blame.